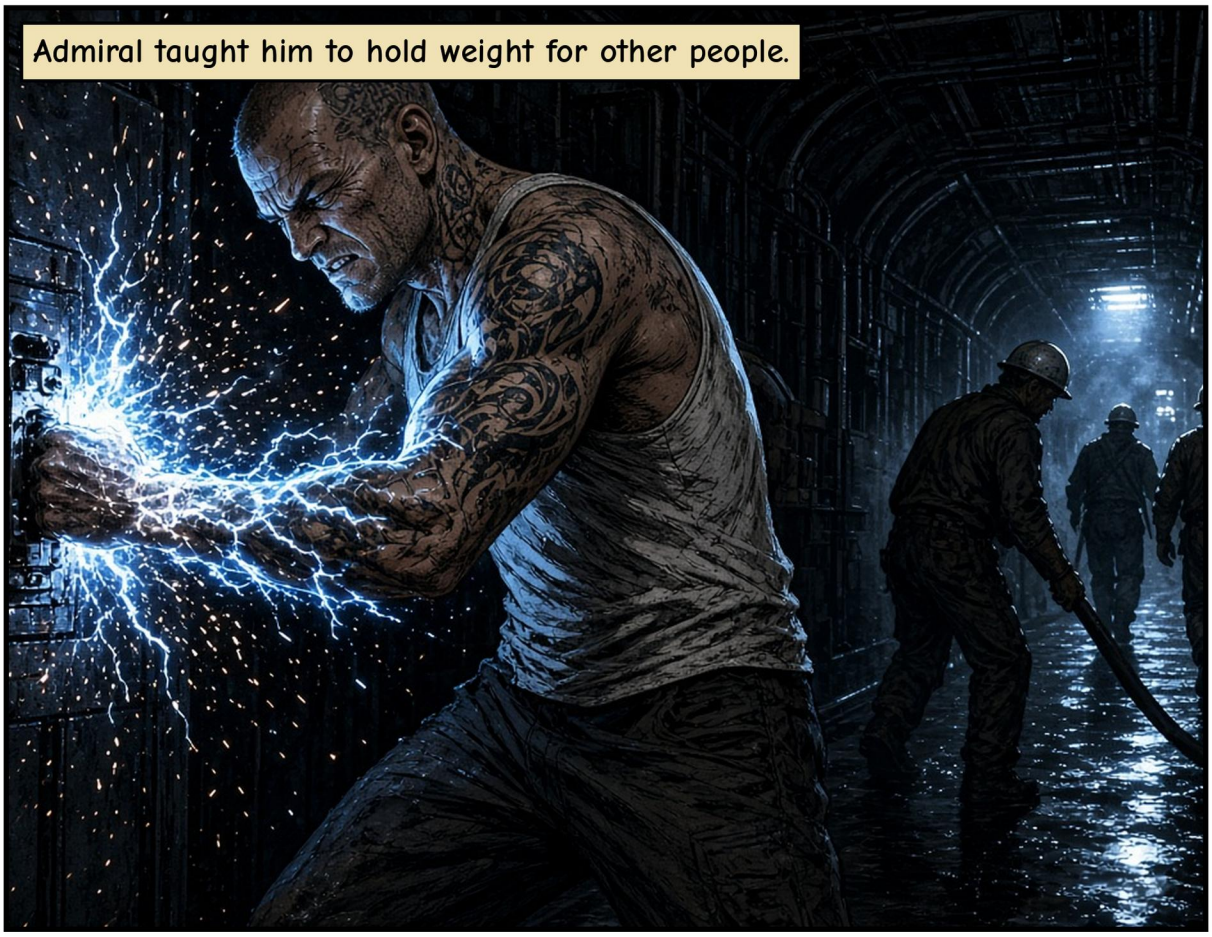
SOLACE

THE LIGHT STAYS ON



CHAOTIC DESIGNS

ISSUE #3


Admiral taught him to hold weight for other people.


The scar branches white. He stops rolling that sleeve down.

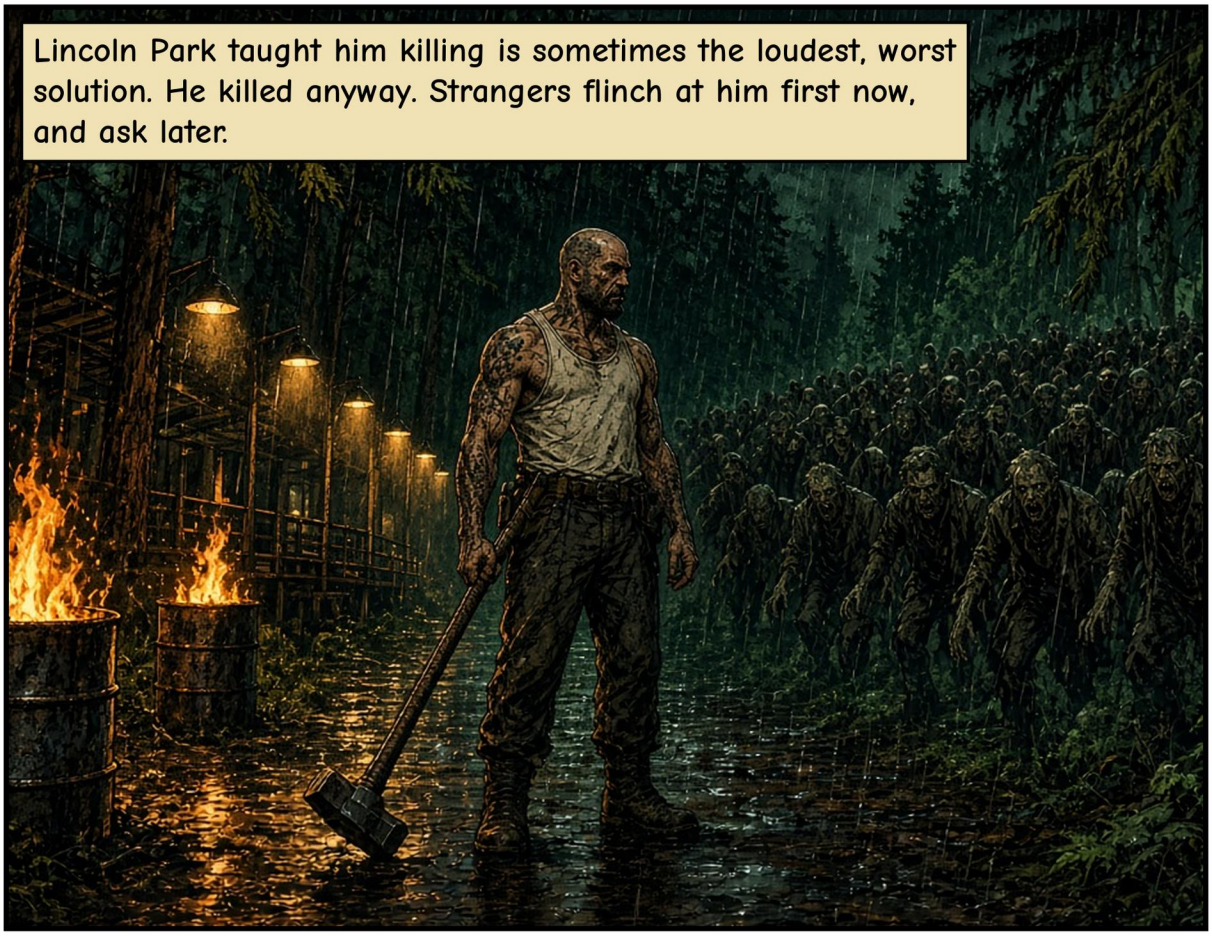

Then gone. He does.
MISSY (RADIO)
...KEEP WALKING...


NIA
WHITE CLOTH, SAFE. BENT ANTENNA, JUMP. NO MARK...
IAN
LISTEN.
NIA
YOU LEARN FAST.


The medicine mattered more than the noise. It usually does.
NIA
YOU CAN'T CARRY ME AND FIGHT.
IAN
WATCH.


He cannot use his largest weapons. He uses himself instead. The bandage on that shoulder stays for two districts. Nia learns to check it without asking.
NIA
GAP, NOW!

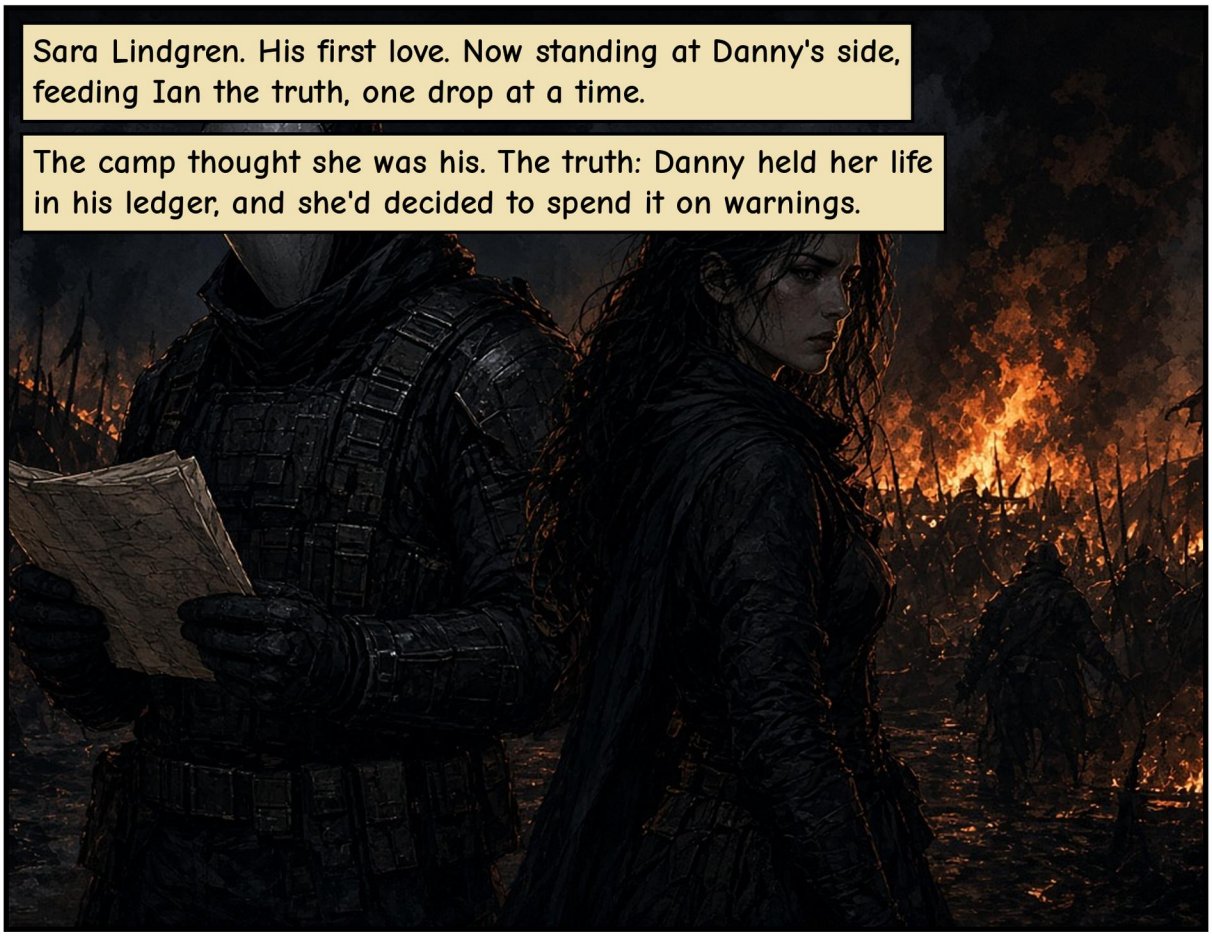

ELI
GUNFIRE HERE WAKES ALL OF IT.
IAN
HOW MANY?
ELI
YOU DON'T WANT THE NUMBER.

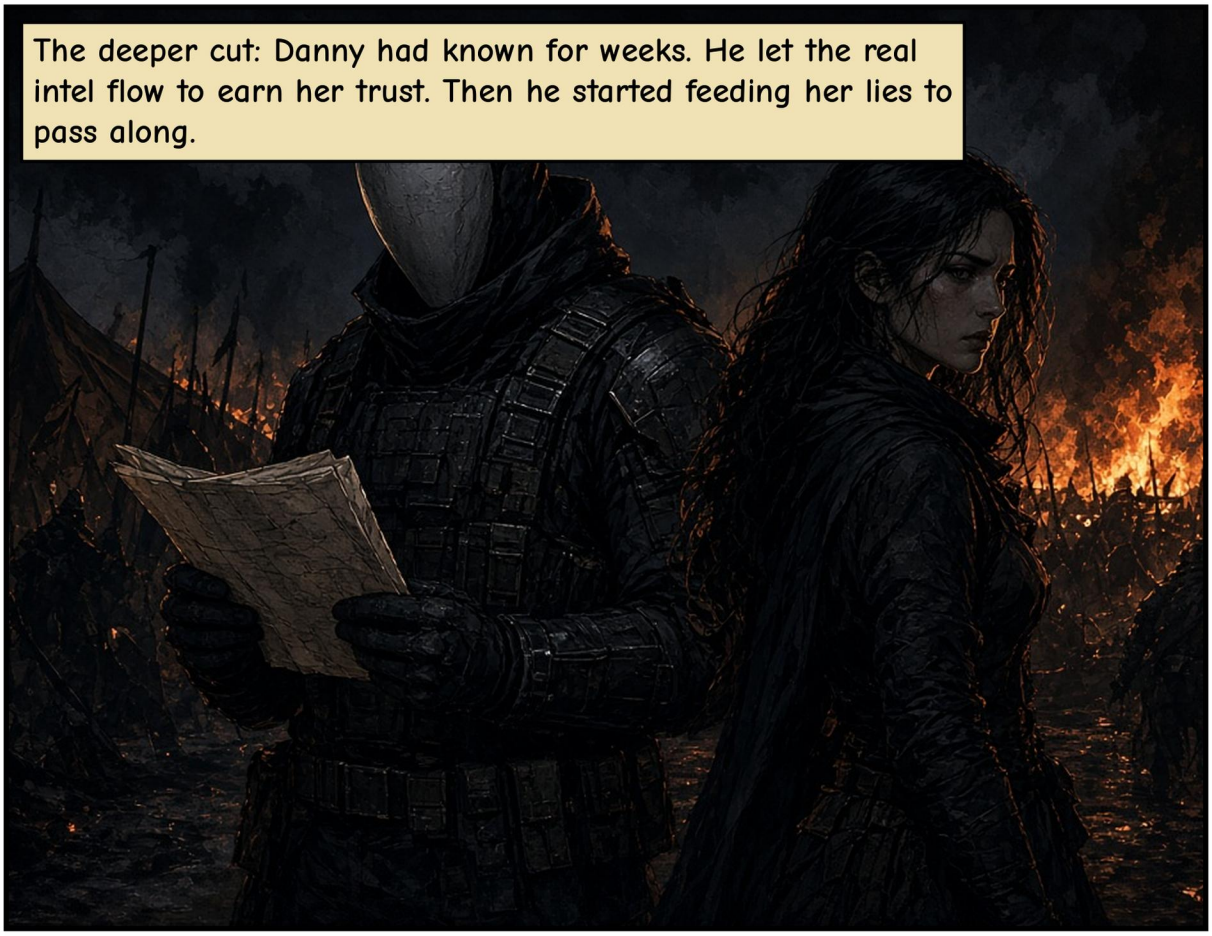

Lincoln Park taught him killing is sometimes the loudest, worst solution. He killed anyway. Strangers flinch at him first now, and ask later.


Every route converged at her clinic. Every decision he'd made was lying on a cot, looking at him.
SORA
STAY FOR THE NAMES.


He doesn't argue. She hands him the field kit that opens High Point's inner gate, and the bill comes with it: remember everyone.
SORA
YOU KEEP PAYING IN THE SAME CURRENCY.


He offered power for Westlight's keys. Missy refused. Her grid was failing anyway. That's what made it a good offer.
DANNY (RADIO)
THE SEAL IS MERCY. THE OUTSIDE WILL BURN THIS PENINSULA THE MOMENT IT OPENS. I ONLY ASK HIGH POINT FOR THE KEYS, SO NO ONE HAS TO DIE PROVING IT.


Sara Lindgren. His first love. Now standing at Danny's side, feeding Ian the truth, one drop at a time.
The camp thought she was his. The truth: Danny held her life in his ledger, and she'd decided to spend it on warnings.


The deeper cut: Danny had known for weeks. He let the real intel flow to earn her trust. Then he started feeding her lies to pass along.


The east span charges were live. Danny held the detonator. And his men would not pull back at dawn. The lie rode all the way to the bridge, unless someone burned themselves to stop it.


TO BE CONTINUED...